

Taylor Nguyen
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Summary

Backend engineer with 9 years on high-throughput distributed systems, mostly in logistics and payments. Happiest owning a service end to end: design, deploy, on-call, and the postmortem when it breaks.

Experience

Senior Software Engineer, Meridian Fulfillment (2021 - present)

Designed and shipped the event-driven order pipeline that processes 40 million events per day on AWS Lambda, EventBridge, and SQS. Cut p99 latency from 900ms to 120ms by replacing synchronous fan-out with a buffered consumer.

Led the migration of the billing service from a monolith onto ECS Fargate. Wrote the Terraform modules, the blue/green deploy pipeline, and the rollback runbook the on-call rotation still follows.

Introduced Apache Kafka as the backbone for cross-team data exchange: 14 topics, Avro contracts enforced by a schema registry, and consumer-lag alerting that catches a stalled consumer within two minutes.

Owned the CI/CD platform for roughly 40 engineers. GitHub Actions runners on autoscaling EC2 plus a shared build cache brought mean build time from 11 minutes down to 4.

Rebuilt the on-call rotation after a quarter averaging six pages a week. Wrote the postmortem process, ran 23 postmortems over 18 months, and tracked action items to completion; repeat incidents fell by about half.

Led a team of five engineers through two performance cycles, including writing promotion packets for two of them.

Software Engineer, Harbor Payments (2018 - 2021)

Built and operated the settlement service handling roughly \$2M in daily transaction volume. Designed the idempotency and retry model that made duplicate settlement runs safe.

Migrated the primary datastore from MySQL to PostgreSQL with under four minutes of write downtime, using logical replication and a dual-write verification window.

Added distributed tracing across seven services with OpenTelemetry, which turned a recurring 'the API is slow' complaint into a specific N+1 query in one downstream service.

Software Engineer, Harbor Payments (2016 - 2018)

Maintained internal REST APIs in Java and Python. Wrote the integration test suite that made the twice-weekly release train possible.

Built the internal rate-limiting library that three teams adopted, after two outages traced back to a single client retrying aggressively without backoff.

Backend Developer, Ridgeline Software (2015 - 2016)

First engineering job. Wrote CRUD services in Java against an Oracle database for a warehouse client, and learned most of what I know about writing code other people have to read.

Automated a manual weekly inventory reconciliation that had been taking an analyst most of a day, which is still the change I am proudest of relative to its size.

Selected work

Idempotency toolkit: a small library making retried writes safe across four services, built after a

duplicate-settlement incident. Keyed on a client-supplied request id with a 24-hour dedup window in Redis, falling back to a database constraint when the cache is cold - because the cache is exactly what fails during an incident.

Schema migration runbook: documented the expand/contract pattern the team now uses for every column change, after a rename shipped in a single deploy took the checkout service down for 11 minutes.

Cost review: found that 30% of the AWS bill came from a logging sidecar shipping DEBUG output from every pod. Sampling brought it down without losing the traces we actually used.

Talks and writing

Internal tech talk: 'What our postmortems actually taught us', a review of 23 incidents and the three root causes that accounted for most of them.

Wrote the team's service-design checklist covering SLOs, idempotency, backpressure, and rollback, now used at design review.

Skills

Languages: Go, Python, Java

Infrastructure: AWS (Lambda, ECS, EventBridge, SQS, S3, EC2), Terraform, Docker, Kubernetes

Data: PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, Apache Kafka

Operations: Datadog, OpenTelemetry, GitHub Actions, incident response, SLOs and error budgets

Education

B.S. Computer Engineering, Gulf Coast Institute of Technology (2016)